ENG-0025

Postmortem Report: auth-pipeline System Incidents

Impact

The auth-pipeline system, part of Project Zephyr, experienced two recent incidents that affected its operational stability. Both incidents were classified as Severity Level 2 (Sev2), indicating moderate impact on system functionality. The incidents caused temporary disruptions, with resolution times of 5.5 hours for INC-019 and 6.5 hours for INC-051. While the system's criticality is designated as medium, these events highlight areas for process improvement to prevent future occurrences.

Timeline

- **INC-019** was reported by E-016 and related to a configuration change. The incident was resolved after 5.5 hours.
- **INC-051** was reported by E-018 and stemmed from a deployment error. The resolution was completed after 6.5 hours.

Both incidents occurred within a close timeframe, underscoring the need for enhanced change management procedures.

Root Cause

- **INC-019**: The root cause was identified as a configuration change that was improperly implemented.
- **INC-051**: The root cause was a deployment error during system update procedures.

Action Items

- Review and strengthen change management protocols to mitigate risks associated with configuration changes.
- Implement additional deployment validation steps to prevent errors during system updates.
- Conduct training sessions for relevant personnel to improve deployment accuracy.
- Assign ongoing monitoring responsibilities to Daniel Kennedy, who is the on-call employee for auth-pipeline, to ensure rapid response to future issues.

This postmortem aims to inform ongoing efforts within Project Zephyr to enhance the stability and reliability of the auth-pipeline system. Continuous improvement will be prioritized to reduce incident frequency and impact.

Additional Personnel

- **Debra Davidson**, the project lead for Project Zephyr, will oversee the implementation of these action items. She is a Sales Executive based in Singapore, with a hire date of July 25, 2023, and a salary band of L4. Her email is debra.davidson@orbitalcorp.com.au.